

Alexander Graham Bell

The man whose invention got the world TALKING, and made it seem a little bit smaller

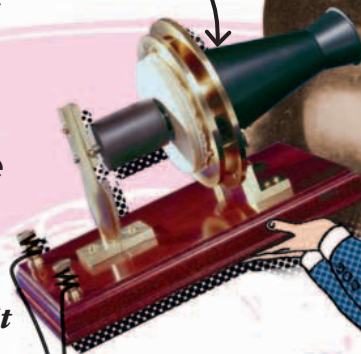
All about me

- **BORN:** 1847
- **DIED:** 1922
- **NATIONALITY:** Scottish
- **FACTOID:** I also invented the first metal detector.
- **IN A NUTSHELL:** I was born in Edinburgh, Scotland, but lived and worked in both the US and Canada.

The electrical speech machine

Long-distance messages were once sent by telegraph, which sent electronic code through cables. Bell suspected that he could use the telegraph wires to **transmit a human voice**. In 1875, with the help of American Thomas Watson (1854–1934), he created the first **electrical speech machine** or, as it is now known, the **TELEPHONE**. By 1878, Bell had set up the world's first telephone exchange in Connecticut, USA.

The first words spoken by telephone were: "Mr. Watson, come here, I want to see you."



By the way...
the American inventor Elisha Gray (1835–1901) also invented a version of the telephone, but I beat him to the patent and got all the credit.



Work with the deaf

It was Bell's work with the deaf that eventually led him to invent the telephone and the microphone. **Bell's mother was deaf**, and his father had developed a **VISIBLE SPEECH SYSTEM** to help deaf children learn to speak. In 1872, Bell opened the School of Vocal Physiology and Mechanics of Speech (pictured left) in Boston to help train teachers to **help deaf children** use his father's system.